



WHERE *to* FIND HELP

The amount of my debt is fairly low, but I'd still like to pay it off and not accumulate more.

The type of help a person in debt needs usually depends on the severity of the problems he or she is facing. If the problem is the overuse of credit cards and the total debt is a few hundred dollars, usually the solution can be worked out by writing up a good plan, as I described previously. In that case what is needed is a commitment to avoid further debt and a budget to verify that commitment.

Do I need an adviser before I consolidate my debts?

If a consolidation loan is needed to help bring the monthly payments in line with the income, the help of a good volunteer coach is beneficial. The danger of going deeper into debt is increased by the additional loan unless some monitoring takes place. That's the primary role of the volunteer coach: to be an objective observer and provide accountability.

We just don't see our way out of this mess.